TOP DRAWS

Regional players dominate the public mindspace when it comes to the performance of heads of Indian states

By **KAUSHIK DEKA**



MANEESH AGNIHOTRI

1. YOGI ADITYANATH
Uttar Pradesh
27.1% [19%]

In an unusual move, West Bengal chief minister and Trinamool Congress (TMC) supremo Mamata Banerjee has decided to campaign for the Samajwadi Party (SP) in the run-up to the Uttar Pradesh assembly election scheduled in February and March. To have the chief minister of one state campaigning in another is not unusual except for the fact that Mamata's TMC and Akhilesh Yadav's SP are not part of any formal alliance. Moreover, the TMC has no electoral stake in UP. Yet the SP reached out to Mamata, who had trounced the BJP in West Bengal last year, because it is up against one of the tallest leaders in the saffron stable—Uttar Pradesh chief minister Yogi Adityanath.

For the fourth consecutive time in the INDIA TODAY MOTN poll, the monk-turned-politician has been rated as the most popular chief minister—27.1 per cent of the 60,141 respondents across the country think he has been the best performing chief minister in India. For Yogi Adityanath, it's a jump of eight percentile points since the last MOTN poll in August 2021. However, it has not been a smooth or unmitigated ascent. His acceptance soars in certain geography and caste groups—he ranks top among 45 per cent respondents from north India and 41 per cent respondents from upper-caste Hindus. At the same time, only 10 per cent respondents from south India and 5 per cent Muslim respondents back him as the No.1 CM. Despite his soaring popularity, the Hindutva icon remains a polarising figure in national politics.

Delhi chief minister Arvind Kejriwal is the only

MOST POPULAR CM (ACROSS INDIA)

Respondents across states were asked to rate who they thought to be the best performing CM in the country



2. ARVIND KEJRIWAL
Delhi
19.9% [14%]



3. MAMATA BANERJEE
West Bengal
10.8% [11%]



4. M.K. STALIN
Tamil Nadu
6.7%



5. UDDHAV THACKERAY
Maharashtra
4.9% [5%]



6. Y.S. JAGAN MOHAN REDDY
Andhra Pradesh
3.3% [6%]



7. NAVEEN PATNAIK
Odisha
3.2% [5%]



8. NITISH KUMAR
Bihar
2.3% [5%]

Aug. '21 MOTN figures in []

Note: All respondents across all states were asked to rate the performance of India's 30 chief ministers. The ratings are the perception of all respondents across India. So, 27.1 per cent of 60,141 respondents rated Yogi Adityanath as the No. 1 chief minister in India